

HIGHLIGHTS OF PRI CAPACITY BUILDING

Progress during the reporting period in the project titled “Decentralized Planning Developing Capacities of Gram Panchayats and Block Panchayats for the Preparation of their Five Year and Annual Action Plans related To Livelihood Enhancements” sponsored by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj, Government of India under the Centrally Sponsored scheme “Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Yojana” in 50 panchayats of Sailana and Bajna blocks of Ratlam district as under:

- The survey of the project area, Sailana and Bajna blocks were conducted and primary and secondary data involving the devolution and delegation of powers under Panchayati Raj Institutions were critically analyzed. Under the preparatory phase and the launch of the capacity building programme in the district *Panchayat Maha Sammelan* for the elected members of *Gram Panchayat* and *Janpad Panchayat* has been organized with district officials and Block level officials at both the blocks. Sailana - 7th Sept 2008, Bajna – 11th Sept 2008.
- NLRI has recruited 5 professional trainers to execute the plan. These master trainers were meticulously trained for imparting quality trainings at institute and in panchayats. One project coordinator and one mentor has assigned for the strategic development and technical/quality input.
- The TNA also gave a clear understanding about the level of awareness in the critical areas of functioning of Panchayati Raj Institutions and helped the team in designing the course modules. The team decided to use innovative ASK¹ model coupling it with the interactive learning sessions, field exercises and audio visual aids. Systematic training need assessment has been done for the members through quiz (*Prashnotari*), open discussion, focused group discussion, feedback from block level officials and other government departments.
- Printing of ID cards, registration form, training diary, panchayat profile formats for villages and elected members.
- Build the capacities of Panchayat representatives in enabling them to fulfill their institutional responsibility of planning for economic development and social justice. 25 villages Sarpanch, Panch, Secretary and Yojana Dal members were identified and informed about the capacity building programme and further preparation of annual and five year plan through *Jila Panchayat* and block offices.
- As per the GoI guidelines 12 number of modules has been developed for specified subjects. Modules are framed in simple vernacular language with local examples and references. Looking to the low literacy level training design is more of pictorial, dramas, film shows, posters and participatory. To development of training design, training material and

¹ ASK – Attitude, Skill and Knowledge Model mooted by NLRI



manuals that can be used for replication during up-scaling of the project. Field testing of study material and module content has been tested with the target audience and government officials.

- Logistic arrangements at village level including transportation, refreshment and quality check on training material and other arrangements.
- Developed a cadre of trained persons in the process of planning at the village and Gram Panchayat. Jankars were also trained to further handholding support for the elected members in the village.
- Monitoring and reporting system developed for a close examination of the implementation plan and for efficient and effective execution of the plan.
- Exposure visit of elected representative to institute for better learning environment and understanding of subject. Two days residential trainings at NLRI have widened the thinking level of members.
- Lecturing by external experts and district officials for updation and latest amendments. One to one discussion with district and Block CEO has helped the elected members for clarification on many legal and constitutional aspects of Panchayati Raj System.
- Detailing of different government scheme like NREGA, TSC, TLC, and NRHM etc has made them more confident of availing the available benefits. These schemes were explained by the concern department experts.
- All 12 module material is available with the master trainers and elected members for reference and multiple use of the information. Material is under printing on quality laminated paper for longer life in village.
- Awareness level among the members has been remarkably increased. Especially the women members are confident enough to share the experiences during the trainings. The level of inquisitiveness of acquiring the information can easily be observed during any capacity building programme.
- Evident support from block level and district level has been taken for widespread impact and understanding on the programme by elected members.
- Cooperation of local leaders has also supported and NLRI has utilized the support very positively in strengthening the panchayat members.
- Collector, Ratlam and CEO Zila Panchayat Ratlam has appreciated the efforts of GVT-NLRI and rewarded memento on 26th Jan 2009 for overall efforts in district.

Highlights of the recent developments in the project:

- Panchayat profiles for all the 50 Panchayats in the project area have been developed with help of members of the Panchayat, *Yojna Dal* and



the members of the local communities in active consultation with grass functionaries and officials interfacing with community on regular basis. All available and potential resources in the Panchayat have been identified and assessed meticulously as probable sources of income Panchayat bodies.

- Annual plans have been developed for 49 Panchayats; these plans are now being discussed in the respective *Gram Sabhas* for their approval. An elaborate plan with the financial obligations on Panchayat or support from district or support from relevant scheme is under process.
- Panchayat plans varies in the range of 30 Lakh to 1 Crore depending on the actual need and utility of the activity for *Panchayat*. Major activities identified are construction of productive village assets and economic infrastructures like tanks, stop / check dam any other appropriate rainwater harvesting structure, installation of hand pump for assured drinking water supply and plantation work. At places need of school building, Anganwadi and sub primary health centers have been articulated and provisions have been made in the respective plans for all such missing infrastructures as well;
- Integrating all implementation projects like Micro Insurance Health Project, Organic WADI, ATMA, Skill Development training programme, Construction skill and Block printing training programme.
- Total number of elected representative trained are as under for 12 modules

Total Training programme conducted	351 events
Janpad Member	46 Participants
Sarpanch	522 Person days of 50 <i>Sarpanchs</i>
Panch	8428 Person days of <i>Panchs</i> from 50 Panchayats
Secretary	380 Person days of Secretaries from 50 Panchayats
Yojana dal	4110 Person days of members of YDs from 50 Panchayats
TOTAL	13837 person days

